



GREY BANNER ALERT



mainroads
WESTERN AUSTRALIA

SHW Serious Incident (SI) – Final Notice

Date of Incident:	7/9/2022	Time of Incident:	0725
Region / Directorate:	Kimberley	Main Roads or Contractor:	Contractor
EQSafe Event Type:	Injury	EQSafe Incident Number:	28225
Actual Consequence:	Insignificant	Potential Consequence:	Major

Incident Short Description:	Operator falls out of Roller while reversing with door open, avoids being crushed, climbs back into moving roller, and shuts it off successfully.
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Executive Summary:

On Wednesday the 7th of September at 6:00am an operator of a padfoot roller had not signed onto a project SWMS however, conducted a Prestart check. The operator identified that the padfoot roller had no flashing beacon, mirror was broken, and the air conditioner was not working. Even though the plant had the identified issues it was deemed fit to be operated. Due to the aircon not working the operator decided to operate the Padfoot roller with the door open and with a donut cushion on the seat as the operator stated the seat was not comfortable.

The operator then commenced work, at 7:25 am the padfoot roller operator was instructed to move off the work area and park up. At this time the padfoot roller was situated on a slight slope and started reversing along a tree line. While reversing the operator hit a bump causing them to fall out of the padfoot roller backwards onto the ground floor. The padfoot roller was still in gear and continued to roll, the operator had to quickly move their legs to avoid them being crushed. The operator then jumped up and climbed back into the padfoot roller whilst it was still in motion to successfully stop the roller.

A supervisor witnessed the incident and went over to ask what had happened and if the operator had their seatbelt on, the operator responded with "yes it must have unbuckled itself". The supervisor conducted a first aid check on the operator; however, their first aid training was not current. The supervisor stood the padfoot roller down and drove the operator back to the company service vehicle and back to Banana Wells accommodation.

There are statements that suggested the worker was not wearing their seatbelt while operating the roller.

Incident Photos:



Padfoot Roller with door open



Seatbelt in the Padfoot Roller



Location of where the incident occurred

Contributing Factors:

- Hazard identification, the operator did not assess the hazard with the door open and use of the donut cushion.
- The safe work method statement (SWMS) was Absent for the task
- The operator did not wear a seat belt and had not signed onto a SWMS
- Surface Gradient/Conditions – Operator hit a bump along the tree line, uneven surface

Corrective Actions:

- Review first aiders to ensure training is current.
- Develop flow chart of plant management process for when pre-starts are completed, and issues are identified and dealt with.
- Review project risk register
- Pre – start topic on safe work method statements

Additional Issues/Learnings:

- Ensure all workers have signed onto the SWMS
- If equipment is unsafe every operator has the right to stop task
- Always wear a seatbelt



Critical Risk:

This serious potential incident aligns with the Main Roads Critical Risk Profile relating to **Mobile plant and Fall from Height.**

Distribution of Notice:

Main Roads Personnel and Contracting Organisations